Day 18 - Rattlesnake Point, Crawford Lake, Leech Porter

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Iroquoia section · hike 25 · Rattlesnake Point & Crawford Lake

12.4 km / 7.7 mi	~3.8 h	5.0 km new	46 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

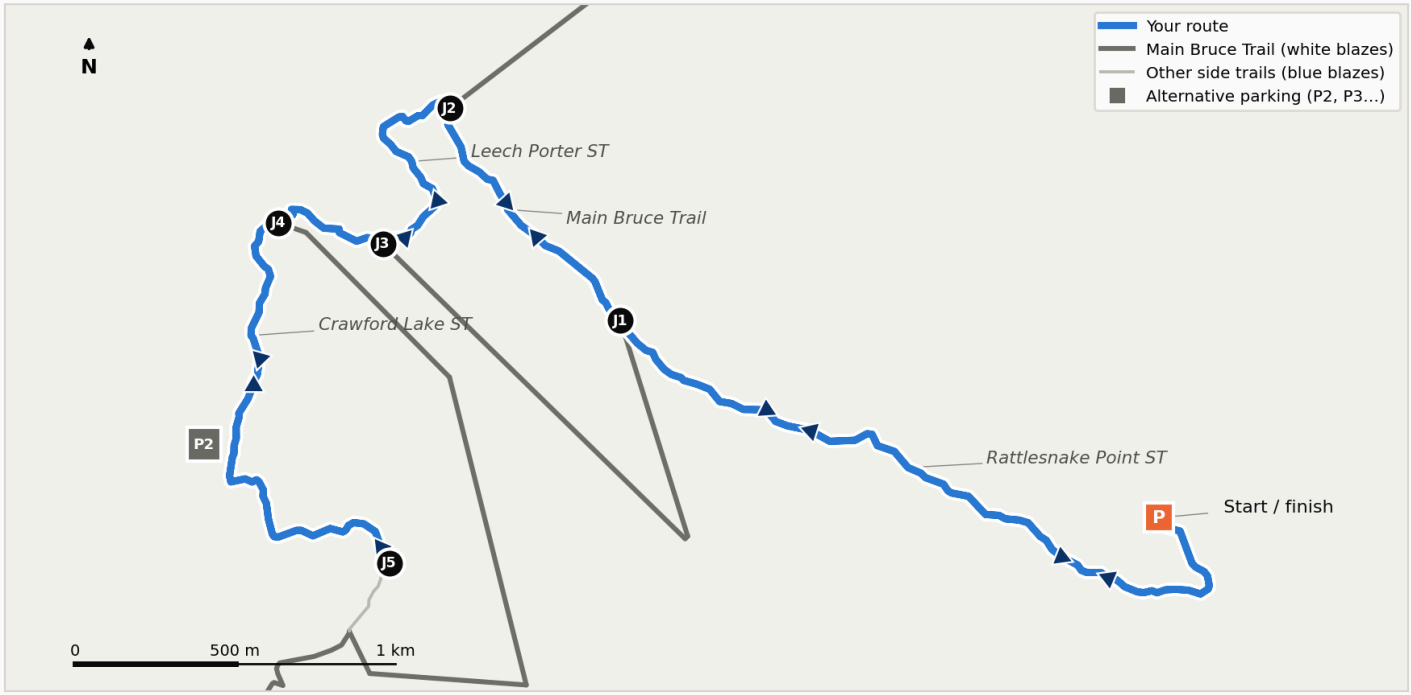
Park (P): Reservation system in effect. Rattlesnake Point Conservation Area: Enter from Appleby Line, 1 km north of Derry Rd. Google Maps. **Paid: $12 per adult at gate, $10.50 online (+HST); no separate vehicle fee · book ahead** · book/pay online at parkvisit.ca, or at gate (call button if unstaffed); Booking ahead strongly advised (BTC: reservation system in effect); walk-ups only if capacity; CH vehicle membership $165 covers a carload

Navigate: import *day18_hike025.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Rattlesnake Point Side Trail (2.5 km); Crawford Lake Side Trail (1.7 km); Leech Porter Side Trail (0.8 km)

Route map

Day 18 | 12.4 km (7.7 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Rattlesnake Point Conservation Area, entered from Appleby Line 1 km north of Derry Rd. Gate fees apply and a reservation system is in effect; booking online also saves on the gate fee. Open 8:30 a.m. to 7 p.m. The lower lot closes in winter and the upper lot is small; do not park on nearby roads.
- **Rattlesnake Point Side Trail:** Inside the conservation area along the escarpment cliffs. Buffalo Crag Lookout has one of the best views on the escarpment, and turkey vultures often soar overhead. The cliffs are used for rock climbing, so keep Zappy close near edges.
- **Leech Porter Side Trail:** Crosses Nassagaweya Canyon on a 150 m boardwalk over Limestone Creek. Expect a gradual descent into forest and a steady climb up the canyon wall.
- **Crawford Lake Side Trail:** Reaches Crawford Lake Conservation Area, with its boardwalk around a meromictic lake and a reconstructed 15th-century longhouse village. Main trails there include steep, rocky slopes.
- **Dogs:** Conservation Halton requires leashes no longer than 2 m. Dogs may not swim in Crawford Lake.
- **Length:** At 12.6 km this is a full day; bring plenty of water for you and Zappy.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Crawford Lake Conservation Area: Enter from Conservation Rd (formerly Steeles Ave), just east… map	Paid: $12 per adult at gate, $10.50 online (+HST); no separate vehicle fee · book ahead	5.5	210 m	Crawford Lake

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 5.0 km / 3.1 mi, covering Rattlesnake Point. **Outing 2** from P2 (Crawford Lake Conservation Area: Enter from Conservation Rd (formerly Steeles Ave), just east…; Paid: $12 per adult at gate, $10.50 online (+HST); no separate vehicle fee · book ahead): 6.2 km / 3.8 mi, covering Crawford Lake, Leech Porter. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Reservation system in effect. Head south-east on the blue-blazed Rattlesnake Point Side Trail.
2.5	1.5	J1: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
3.4	2.1	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Leech Porter Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
4.1	2.6	J3: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
4.5	2.8	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Crawford Lake Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
6.2	3.8	J5: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
7.8	4.9	J4: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
8.2	5.1	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
8.2	5.1	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Leech Porter Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
9.0	5.6	J2: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
9.9	6.2	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Rattlesnake Point Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
12.4	7.7	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Conservation Halton and Ontario Hiking.